

Mild Asthma, Wheezing, & Shortness of Breath

Asthma is usually triggered by an allergic reaction to substances such as pollen, dust, animal hair, or certain foods, but may also be related to an infection. The listed remedies will relieve immediate symptoms, but in order to find the cause of your ailment, or for long-term treatment, it is best to consult an herbalist. All the herbal remedies that are suggested here can be taken alongside conventional treatment. Herbs such as nettle, thyme, cramp bark, and echinacea help to ease breathing, while essential oil of German chamomile reduces inflammation.

General cautions Seek professional help for asthma. Do not stop using steroidal or other inhalants. Their use should be phased out gradually and only with professional guidance.

Wheezing & Shortness of Breath

Herbs Nettle (*Urtica dioica*, p. 146), thyme (*Thymus vulgaris*, p. 143)

Remedy Make an infusion using 15 g of each herb to 3 cups of water and drink throughout the day.

Herb German chamomile (*Chamomilla recutita*, p. 77)

Remedy Make an infusion with 2 heaping tsp of the herb to $\frac{3}{4}$ cup (150 ml) of water and leave to stand for 10 minutes in a covered saucepan. Remove the lid, inhale the steam, and strain and drink the tea.

Option Use the essential oil in a steam inhalation, or inhale 2 drops of undiluted oil placed on a handkerchief.

Herb Baical skullcap (*Scutellaria baicalensis*, p. 134)

Remedy Make a decoction and take up to 1 $\frac{1}{4}$ cups (300 ml) a day.

Breathing Difficulty & Tight Chest

Herb Cramp bark (*Viburnum opulus*, p. 150)

Remedy Take 1 tsp of tincture with water up to 8 times a day for 3 days, then reduce the dose to a maximum of 1 tsp 3 times a day for 7 days.

Mild Bronchial Asthma from Colds & Chest Infections

Herb Echinacea (*Echinacea* spp., p. 92)

Remedy Take tablets or capsules, or $\frac{1}{2}$ tsp of tincture with water 2–3 times a day.

Circulatory Problems



Witch Hazel
(*Hamamelis virginiana*)

To maintain good health, the body's ten trillion cells need to be bathed in fluid that brings them vital nutrients and removes waste products. When this process is undermined by poor circulation, the body may react with conditions such as raised blood pressure, which places a long-term strain on the heart. A high-vegetable, low-sugar diet and regular aerobic exercise help to keep the heart active and the arteries clear of fatty deposits that can clog up their linings. A number of herbs act preventively to sustain good circulation—few more so than garlic (*Allium sativum*, p. 59).

Seek immediate professional advice for:

- Severe chest pain
- Palpitations lasting several minutes
- Hot, swollen, or ulcerated tender veins, or dark red discoloration of the skin or veins
- Fainting or dizziness with weakness, numbness, or tingling in any part of the body

Anemia

There are several types of anemia. Iron deficiency anemia, caused by blood loss from a wound or menstrual bleeding, can be countered with herbs. Bitter herbs, such as gentian, improve the absorption of nutrients, and nettle contains plenty of iron. Increase your intake of other green herbs that contain iron.

General caution Seek professional advice to determine the type of anemia you have before home treatment.

General Remedies

Herbs Gentian (*Gentiana lutea*, p. 99), wormwood (*Artemisia absinthium*, p. 66)

Remedy Take 2–5 drops of either tincture with water, half an hour before meals.

Caution Do not take wormwood during pregnancy.

Herb Chiretta (*Swertia chirata*, p. 273)

Remedy Take 5–10 drops of tincture with water 3 times a day before meals.

Anemia due to Heavy Menstrual Bleeding

Herb Nettle (*Urtica dioica*, p. 146)

Remedy Make an infusion using 25 g of herb to 3 cups (750 ml) of water. Sip the whole dose at intervals throughout the day.

See also *Heavy Menstrual Bleeding*—Four Things Soup remedy, p. 315.

High Blood Pressure & Arteriosclerosis

Mild cases of high blood pressure and arteriosclerosis (hardening of the arteries) can benefit from herbs. Garlic thins the blood, reduces fatty deposits, and lowers blood pressure; beetroot and ginkgo aid circulation, reduce blood pressure, and prevent arteriosclerosis; and ginger improves circulation, especially to the capillaries.

General caution Seek professional advice, especially if already taking medication for a circulatory condition.

General Remedies

Herbs Garlic (*Allium sativum*, p. 59), beet (*Beta vulgaris*, p. 178), pomegranate (*Punica granatum*, p. 259)

Remedy Take a garlic tablet or eat 1–2 fresh garlic cloves each day. Drink $\frac{1}{2}$ cup (125 ml) of beetroot or pomegranate juice once a day.

Note These are most effective when used to support a healthy circulation and prevent illness.

Herb Ginkgo (*Ginkgo biloba*, p. 100)

Remedy Take tablets or $\frac{1}{2}$ tsp of fluid extract with water twice a day for approximately 2–3 months at a time.

Herb Ginger (*Zingiber officinale*, p. 155)

Remedy Grate 1 tsp of fresh ginger into your food each day.